

SILVA BASHLLARI

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Data scientist and researcher with a strong interdisciplinary profile at the intersection of computational methods, economics, and social analysis. Experienced in machine learning, statistical modelling, and mixed-methods research applied to real-world datasets, including nationally representative surveys. My MSc thesis examined AI's impact on labour markets through an anthological and mixed-methods lens, directly relevant to EADS research streams on economics, analytics, and decision sciences. Active in science communication, open-source communities, and policy-oriented research across Europe and the Western Balkans.

EDUCATION

MSc in Data Science and Engineering — Grade: 106/110 Polytechnic of Turin, Italy Thesis: Tales of Work in the Age of The Blind Watchmakers (AI): An Anthological & Mixed-Methods Study of the Clashes of Schools of Thought and Public Perceptions. Activities: BEST (Board of European Students of Technology) — Topic Manager, EBEC 2021	09/2021 – 12/2025
Summer School on Responsible AI and Financial Literacy European Forum Alpbach, Austria	08–09/2023
Academy for Social Democracy Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung (FES), Albania	10–11/2020
BA in Business Informatics — Grade: 10/10 Mediterranean University of Albania Activities: Student Senate Member	09/2018 – 07/2021

SKILLS

Technical <i>Proficient</i>	
Languages	Python, SQL
DS & ML	Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, Matplotlib, Seaborn, PyTorch, NetworkX, NLTK, SciPy, etc.
Concepts	Machine Learning, Statistical Modelling, Regression, Classification, Clustering, NLP, Dimensionality Reduction, Feature Engineering, Data Visualization
Tools	Jupyter Lab, VS Code, LaTeX, Canva, Microsoft Office
Technical <i>Familiar</i>	
Dev & Ops	Bash, Git & GitHub, Docker, Ubuntu / Linux
Databases	MongoDB, Hadoop, Spark
Other	Tableau, R, HuggingFace SmolAgents, Java
Non-Technical	
Communication	Science Communication, Public Speaking, Technical Writing, Media Interviews
Research	Mixed-Methods Research, Survey Design, Policy Report Writing, Academic Writing
Leadership	Community Leadership, Conference Organisation, Workshop Facilitation, Team Coordination, Programme Curation & Panel Moderation, Working Group Lead
Languages	Albanian (Native), English (C2 – TOEFL iBT), Italian (B2 – CELI 3), French (A2)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Invited Expert & Workshop Facilitator — AI & Critical Thinking Council of Europe – North-South Centre Madrid, Spain - Designed and delivered a workshop on AI and critical thinking at the Global Education Annual Meeting. - Explained key AI concepts and model architectures to non-technical international audiences.	04/2026
Research Fellow SHARE Foundation Remote / Skopje, North Macedonia - Fellowship on digital rights, security, and AI with focus on data collection and extraction practices. - Analyzed perceptions around digital rights, modeled relationships between key actors, and used data visualization to communicate patterns.	04/2026 – 06/2026
External Research Associate & Data Scientist Center for Comparative and International Studies (CCIS), Albania Project-Based, supported by the Swiss Embassy in Albania Conducted research and data analysis on surveys about trust and usage of data from non-state actors (businesses, universities, etc.) in Albania using Python and visualization tools.	08/2025 – 11/2025

- Produced a formal policy report on the findings, typeset in LaTeX, in collaboration with Prof. Dr. Nevila Xhindi.

External Research Associate & Data Scientist

05/2025 – 08/2025

[Network Albania, Albania](#) | Project-Based

- Performed data analysis and served as an advisor for AI-related matters on a project basis.

Assistant Tutor — Programming Courses

10/2020 – 06/2021

[Tirana Center of Technology, Albania](#)

- Delivered hands-on programming instruction in Java and Python to beginner-level learners.

PUBLICATIONS, PUBLIC TALKS & AWARDS

European Research Memberships

- European COST Action – The HUMAN-IT Initiative (CA24164), since December 2025. Coordinator of sub-group 2 of WG3 (AI & labour markets survey design); member of the science communication working group.

Publications & Reports

- [Policy Report: Fostering Trust and Utilization in Albania's Data Landscape](#) – CCIS, supported by the Swiss Embassy in Albania, 2025. Co-author with Prof. Dr. Nevila Xhindi.
- [Report: Understanding Youth Engagement in Technology and Creative Events](#) – C4 Communities Program, Albania, 2025. Co-author with Edis Hasaj.
- The Age of the Blind Watchmakers – Forum Ferdinando Rossi, Torino, Italy, 2022.
- The Pandemic, Digitalization, or Digital Transformation? – Maltepe University Student Congress, Online, 2021.
- [Comparing Effectiveness of Online and Traditional Learning in CS](#) – CIT Review Journal, Albania, 2020. Co-author.

Selected Public Talks & Workshops

- PyCon Italia, Bologna, IT — Speaker: Graph Theory 101 & NetworkX (May 2026)
- PyLadies Prishtina & RIT Kosovo, Prishtina, KS — Workshop Lead: The Mathematics Behind Machine Learning (May 2026)
- PyLadies Prishtina & University of Prishtina, Prishtina, KS — Workshop Lead: Introduction to AI and Machine Learning (April 2026)
- LeapIN Kosova 2026, Prizren, KS — Panelist: AI & The Economy Panel (April 2026)
- 42 Tirana, Girls in ICT Day '26, Tirana, AL — Workshop Lead: Calculus Wars and the beauty behind mathematics (April 2026)
- TV Interview, CNN A2, Tirana, AL — Interviewee: [What is AI?](#) (April 2026)
- Entrepreneurship Week Albania, Tirana, AL — Speaker: AI & Future Skills: The Ethics of the Digital Workforce (November 2025)
- National Skills Competition 10th Edition, Tirana, AL — Speaker: The Future of Work (November 2025)
- Software Freedom Kosovo (SFK25), Prishtina, KS — Speaker & Workshop Lead: AI Impact on Work / [Foundations of Data Science for Non-Technical Audiences](#) (October 2025)
- Anna Lindh Foundation Forum 25, Tirana, AL — Panelist: Tech for Good Panel (June 2025)
- Tirana International Film Festival ([TIFF24](#)), Tirana, AL — Panel Director & Moderator: AI in Movie-making (September 2024)
- The Power Conference 2022, Tirana, AL — Speaker: Intro to Federated Learning (December 2022)

Awards & Competitions

- Participant — AI Act Compass Innovation Challenge, Pisa Internet Festival & Scuola Superiore Sant'Anna (LeADS). Team Leader, one of 7 selected teams. Pisa, Italy, 2024.
- 2nd Prize Winner — Research Competition, Albanian American Development Fund (AADF), CleanScore Project. Tirana, Albania, 2021.

SELECTED GITHUB PROJECTS

- Regression Task on Particle Tracking — Multi-output regression model predicting particle coordinates (x, y) from RSD sensor signals using ensemble models and signal processing.
- Clustering Consumer Spending — K-means clustering on spending behaviour with PCA for dimensionality reduction.
- Federated Learning — Implemented client selection, domain generalisation, and model pruning strategies for heterogeneous data.
- Sentiment Classification of Tweets — Binary sentiment classifier using NLTK and Scikit-learn; Multinomial Naïve Bayes with strong F1 score.

TECH COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Co-Organiser & Programme Curator — LeapIN 2025 & LeapIN 2026

03/2025 – 06/2026

[LDA Europe \(NGO\) | Albania](#)

- Co-organised and curated the programme for two consecutive LeapIN conferences focused on AI and Responsible Innovation in Albania.
- Selected topics and panelists, organised and moderated panels, and led conversations on the responsible use of AI and its societal implications.

Community Founder & Chapter Lead — PyLadies Prishtina

02/2026 – present

[Python Software Foundation Official Chapter | Remote](#)

- Founded and lead the PyLadies Prishtina chapter, promoting Python and inclusion in tech through workshops and community initiatives.
- Fostered exchange and learning with local universities including the University of Prishtina and RIT Kosovo, co-organising workshops and collaborative events.

Community Contributor — FLOSSK

10/2025 – present

[Free Libre Open Source Software Kosova](#) | [Remote](#)

- Speaker and workshop lead at SFK25; core organiser for Software Freedom Kosova 2026.

Grassroots Community Co-Manager — DAIT

06/2024 – 05/2025

[Data and AI Tirana](#) | [Albania](#)

- Organised workshops simplifying AI concepts for general audiences; fostered collaborations between industry experts and academia.

Wikimedia Contributor

02/2020 – 05/2022

[Wikimedians of Albanian Language User Group](#) | [Albania](#)

- Led Wikipedia edit-a-thons focused on women in STEM in collaboration with local universities, facilitating introductory workshops on Wikidata and open knowledge initiatives.